

Can we love our neighbours as ourselves?

Why should I love my neighbour like I love myself? The answer is simple: Because it's the most **sensible** thing to do. Loving your neighbour is the first and best choice among the three choices you have. The first choice is love. The second is hate and the third is **indifference**.

Let's **examine** each choice, beginning with the third choice. **Perhaps**, you don't want to love your neighbour, because he is bad; but yet you wouldn't want to hate him because you are a good person and you avoid negative emotions. So, you are **indifferent** to your neighbour. But indifference or **apathy** is a **cold** emotion. Apathy is as negative as **hatred**. The line between hatred and apathy is very fine. If you meet your neighbour on the street and you ignore him, it doesn't seem like a good and decent thing to do. **The second choice** – hatred – **will** harm you as much as it hurts your neighbour...which leaves you with the first and the best choice – to love your neighbour.

Honestly, **loving** an **irksome** neighbour **is** not as hard as it seems. It simply means respecting the person and thinking of his needs and desires as much as you would your own. You won't be able to love yourself until you first love your neighbour. Whether we like it or not, a major part of our life will always centre on that of our neighbours. Ask yourself some questions and you'll see from the answers how important your neighbour is for your own peace and happiness. You can't just stop at loving your immediate neighbour. You've got to love your neighbour's neighbour too and so on. The circle of love gets wider, **subsuming** differences of community, state, nation, continents – **encompassing** the whole universe and beyond.

Your heart is so big and so full of love; its capacity to love is infinite; it's divine. Inversely, your heart's capacity to hate is limited. Try applying the Golden Rule of infinite love to hate and you'll find yourself **shattered**. That's because you don't have a limitless capacity to hate like you have to love. For, love gives you joy and power and victory and hate brings in **sorrow** and **powerlessness** and defeat. Jesus said in the Bible, 'You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your mind.' This is the greatest and first **commandment**. And the second is: 'You shall love your neighbour as yourself.'...

The Bible **verses** on loving your neighbour **find echo** in the Bhagwad Gita. Krishn says: 'Those **devotees** are very dear to Me who are free from **malice** toward all living beings, who are friendly, and **compassionate**. They are free from attachment to possessions and **egotism**, **equipoised** in happiness and **distress**, and ever-forgiving. They are ever **content**, **steadily** united with Me in devotion, self-controlled, of **firm resolve**, and dedicated to Me in mind and **intellect**, 12:13-14.' The Gita verses mean that those **devotees** who believe in Krishn **know** that every person and other living entities are part of Him. Therefore, such devotees love all persons, irrespective of any differences, real or **perceived**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Sensible** (adjective) – Reasonable, rational, practical, logical समझदारी भरा
2. **Indifference** (noun) – Apathy, unconcern, lack of interest, disregard उदासीनता
3. **Examine** (verb) – Investigate, scrutinize, analyze, inspect जांच करना
4. **Perhaps** (adverb) – Maybe, possibly, conceivably, potentially शायद
5. **Indifferent** (adjective) – Unconcerned, apathetic, detached, disinterested उदासीन
6. **Apathy** (noun) – Indifference, lack of emotion, disinterest, insensitivity उदासीनता
7. **Cold** (adjective) – Unfeeling, unemotional, indifferent, detached उदासीन
8. **Hatred** (noun) – Dislike, loathing, hostility, aversion घृणा
9. **Irksome** (adjective) – Annoying, bothersome, irritating, troublesome कष्टदायक
10. **Subsume** (verb) – Include, absorb, encompass, incorporate शामिल करना
11. **Encompass** (verb) – Surround, include, involve, encircle शामिल करना
12. **Shattered** (adjective) – Broken, devastated, destroyed, crushed टूटे हुए, विध्वस्त
13. **Sorrow** (noun) – Grief, sadness, distress, heartache दुख, पीड़ा
14. **Powerlessness** (noun) – Helplessness, inability, weakness, incapacity बेबस होना
15. **Commandment** (noun) – Rule, decree, instruction, order आज्ञा
16. **Verse** (noun) – Passage, stanza, line, excerpt श्लोक
17. **Echo** (noun) – Resemblance, repetition, reflection, reverberation गूंज
18. **Devotee** (noun) – Worshipper, follower, adherent, disciple भक्त, अनुयायी
19. **Malice** (noun) – Hatred, ill-will, spite, animosity द्वेष, शत्रुता
20. **Compassionate** (adjective) – Kind-hearted, empathetic, caring, benevolent दयालु
21. **Egotism** (noun) – Self-centeredness, arrogance, narcissism, self-importance अहंकार
22. **Equipose** (verb) – Balance, stabilize, equalize, counterbalance संतुलित करना
23. **Distress** (noun) – Suffering, pain, agony, anguish कष्ट

24. **Content** (adjective) – Satisfied, pleased, fulfilled, happy संतुष्ट

25. **Steadily** (adverb) – Consistently, continuously, regularly, unceasingly लगातार

26. **Firm** (adjective) – Strong, resolute, unyielding, unwavering दृढ़

27. **Resolve** (noun) – Determination, decision, willpower, intent संकल्प

28. **Intellect** (noun) – Intelligence, mind, understanding, reasoning बुद्धि

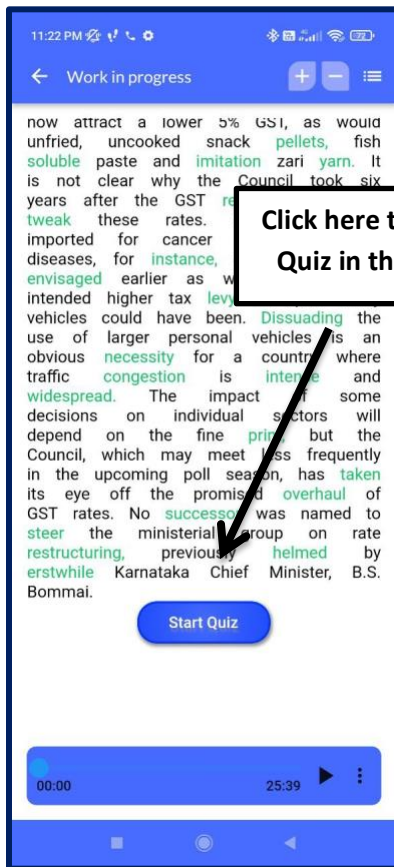
29. **Perceived** (adjective) – Apparent, noticeable, recognized, observed माना जाता

@mocks_wallah

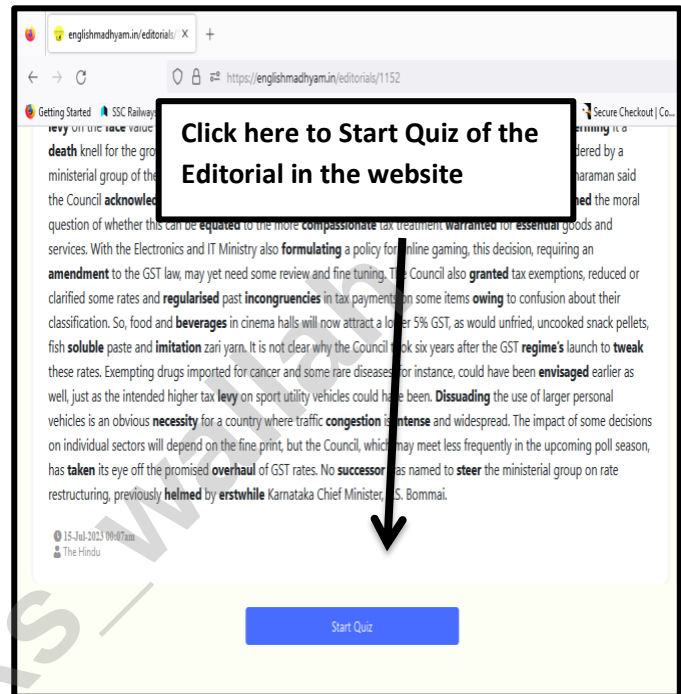
Summary of the Editorial

- **Central Question:** The editorial asks why one should love their neighbor and concludes that it is the most sensible choice among the three options: love, hate, and indifference.
- **Three Choices Explained:**
 - Love is the best and most positive choice.
 - Indifference is as harmful as hatred, as it fosters coldness and negativity.
 - Hatred harms both the one who hates and the one who is hated.
- **Consequences of Indifference:** Ignoring or being apathetic toward a neighbor is neither good nor decent, as it creates a negative environment.
- **Effects of Hatred:** Hatred brings harm, sorrow, and defeat to the one harboring it, making it an undesirable option.
- **Benefits of Love:** Love brings joy, power, and victory, making it the most fulfilling and enriching choice.
- **Love as a Simple Act:** Loving a difficult neighbor involves basic respect and consideration for their needs and desires.
- **Interconnectedness of Lives:** Our peace and happiness are closely tied to our neighbors, making it essential to foster love and harmony with them.
- **Expanding the Circle of Love:** The concept of loving neighbors extends beyond immediate neighbors to encompass communities, nations, and the universe.
- **Infinite Capacity for Love:** The human heart has an infinite capacity for love but a limited capacity for hatred.
- **Golden Rule of Love:** Infinite love is empowering and divine, while hatred depletes and destroys.
- **Biblical Teachings:** The Bible emphasizes loving God wholeheartedly and loving one's neighbor as oneself, highlighting love as a divine commandment.
- **Bhagavad Gita's Parallel Message:** The Gita resonates with the Bible, teaching compassion, malice-free living, forgiveness, and selflessness as the qualities of true devotees.
- **Unity in Diversity:** The Gita states that all beings are part of the divine, encouraging love beyond perceived differences.
- **Power of Compassion:** Compassion and friendliness toward all living beings lead to spiritual growth and peace.
- **Divine Love Over Hatred:** Both religious texts advocate that love is transformative, bridging differences and promoting universal harmony.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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